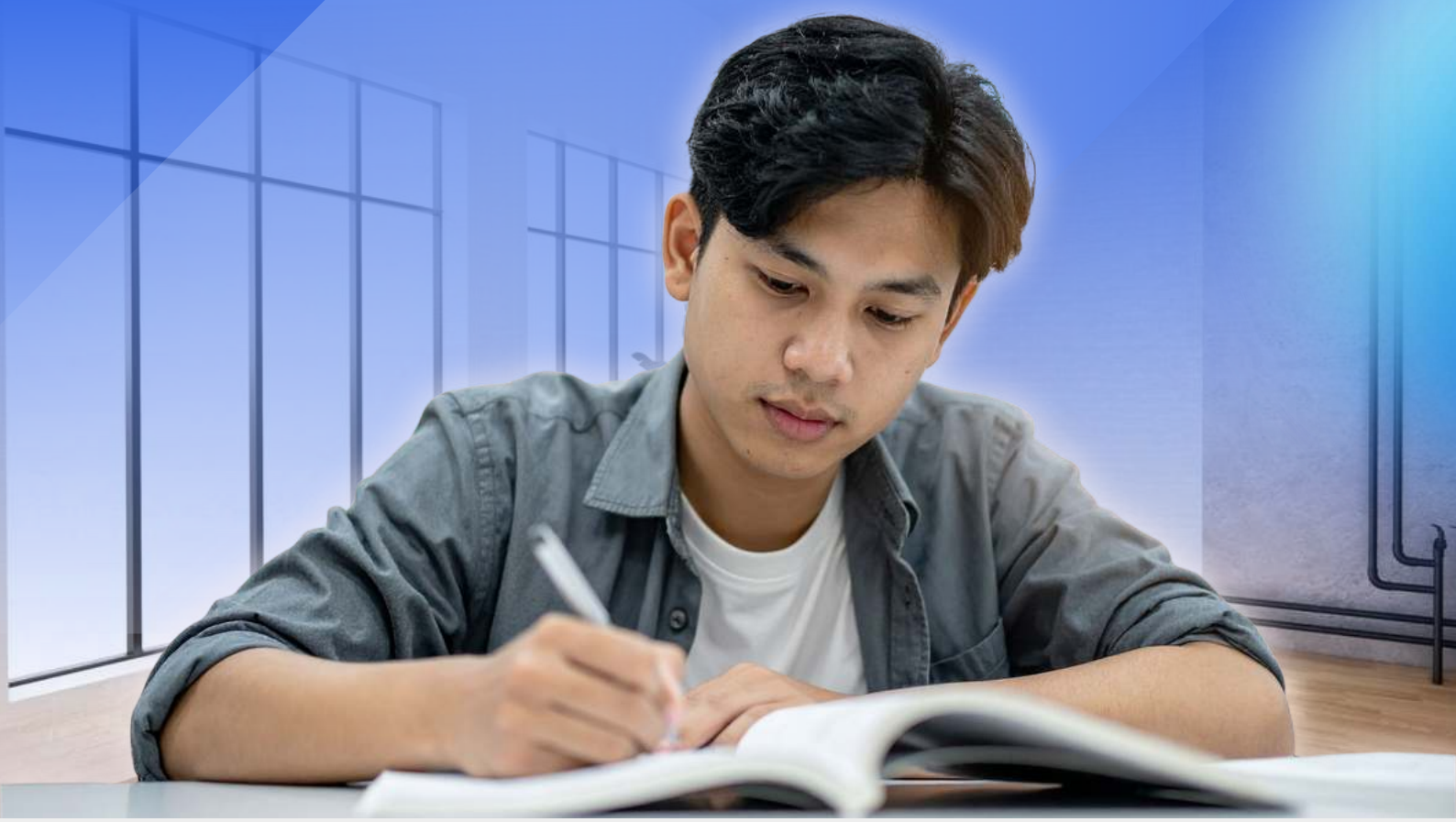
Lenterago

TRY OUT #11

SAT-Reading Writing

61011

54 QUESTIONS



www.lenterago.id
+6282170276076
office@lenterago.id

MODULE 1: Reading and Writing (27 Questions)

Direction:
The questions in this section address a number of important reading and writing skills. Each question includes one or more passages, which may include a table or graph. Read each passage and question carefully, and then choose the best answer to the question based on the passage(s).

All questions in this section are multiple-choice with four answer choices. Each question has a single best answer.

NO	MATERI	SUB MATERI	KUNCI
1	Craft and Structure		
	The following text is from Virginia Woolf's 1929 essay A Room of One's Own. "Intellectual freedom depends upon material things. Poetry depends upon intellectual freedom. And women have always been poor, not for two hundred years merely, but from the beginning of time. Women have had less intellectual freedom than the sons of Athenian slaves. Women, then, have not had a dog's chance of writing poetry. That is why I have laid so much stress on money and a room of one's own." Which choice best describes the function of the underlined sentence in the text as a whole? a. It introduces a historical comparison that diminishes the achievements of Athenian slaves. b. It provides evidence for the claim that material conditions determine intellectual output. c. It contrasts the situation of women with an even more oppressed group in ancient society. d. It emphasizes the extremity of women's historical deprivation through a striking parallel		
2	Craft and Structure		
	The concept of akrasia, or weakness of will, has puzzled philosophers since Socrates. How can one knowingly choose the worse over the better? Socrates famously denied the possibility, arguing that no one errs willingly—apparent akrasia is really ignorance of what is truly good. Aristotle demurred, insisting that we can indeed know what is best and yet, overcome by passion or appetite, fail to act accordingly. The debate has never been resolved, perhaps because it touches on foundational questions about the structure of human agency. Does reason naturally govern action, with failures attributable to cognitive defects? Or is the self a site of internal conflict, where rational and non-rational motivations compete on more equal terms? Contemporary neuroscience, with its mapping of competing brain systems, may be giving us new tools to address this ancient puzzle—though whether empirical findings can resolve philosophical disputes remains an open question. As used in the text, "demurred" most nearly means? a. hesitated b. objected c. delayed d. conceded		

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3	Craft and Structure		
	Text 1 The geographer Ellen Churchill Semple argued that human societies are fundamentally shaped by their physical environment. In her 1911 work Influences of Geographic Environment, she maintained that mountains foster isolation and conservatism, while plains encourage mobility and innovation. Climate, soil, and natural resources determine not only economic possibilities but also temperament, social organization, and even religious beliefs. Semple's environmental determinism, though later criticized as overly rigid, established geography as a serious academic discipline and influenced generations of scholars. Text 2 The French geographer Paul Vidal de la Blache developed an alternative tradition known as possibilism. Rather than viewing the environment as destiny, Vidal emphasized that humans actively shape their surroundings and that the same environment can support diverse cultural adaptations. A mountain range, he argued, does not determine a particular social form; it presents possibilities that different groups may realize differently depending on their history, technology, and values. The physical setting constrains but does not dictate; human agency remains central. Based on the texts, how would Vidal de la Blache (Text 2) most likely respond to Semple's claim (Text 1) that mountains "foster isolation and conservatism"? a. He would agree but add that such effects can be overcome through technological innovation. b. He would argue that mountains have different effects in different historical periods. c. He would maintain that mountains offer multiple possibilities, not a single predetermined outcome. d. He would contend that Semple's claim applies only to certain mountain ranges.		
4	Craft and Structure		
	In his Meditations, the Roman emperor Marcus Aurelius repeatedly exhorts himself to remember the impermanence of all things. "Soon you will have forgotten everything," he writes, "and soon everything will have forgotten you." This is not morbid rumination but philosophical therapy. By contemplating transience, Marcus aims to loosen the grip of worldly attachments—to fame, wealth, power—that he knows cannot ultimately satisfy. If all things pass, then clinging to them is a recipe for suffering. The Stoic practice of memento mori (remembering death) thus serves not to depress but to liberate, clearing the ground for what truly matters: virtue, rationality, and right action in the present moment. The author's attitude toward Marcus Aurelius's practice of contemplating impermanence is best described as one of? a. sympathetic understanding b. critical skepticism c. clinical detachment d. enthusiastic endorsement		
5	Craft and Structure		
	The term "late style" has long preoccupied aesthetic theorists, who detect in the final works of certain artists a distinctive quality—something craggy, unresolved, even perverse. Theodor		

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	Adorno, in his fragmentary meditation on Beethoven, discerned in the composer's last quartets not the serene summation one might expect from a master at the end of his life, but rather a kind of willful asymmetry, as if the music were deliberately turning away from the very conventions that had sustained it. This is not the mellow wisdom of old age, Adorno insisted, but something far more unsettling: the artist standing outside his own work, regarding it with an almost ironic detachment. The late style does not reconcile contradictions; it lets them stand in abrasive juxtaposition. And yet—here is the paradox—this very refusal of harmony generates its own kind of coherence, one that later generations may recognize as the artist's most profound achievement. As used in the text, "craggy" most nearly means? a. Mountainous b. steep and rocky c. irregular and unpolished d. dangerously precipitous		
6	Craft and Structure		
	The chronicler's task is not to judge but to record. Yet this very act of selection—choosing which events to include and which to omit—constitutes a kind of judgment. When the chronicler decides that the king's speech matters more than the peasant's harvest, when the battle receives three paragraphs and the plague only a sentence, a hierarchy of significance emerges. The chronicler becomes, despite all intentions, a moralist. The blank spaces on the page are as eloquent as the words that fill them. Which choice best describes the function of the phrase "the blank spaces on the page"? a. It illustrates the physical limitations of medieval manuscripts b. It symbolizes the events and voices excluded from historical records c. It represents the passage of time between recorded events d. It suggests that historians should write more comprehensively		
7	Craft and Structure		
	Passage 1 The novel as a form has always been preoccupied with individual psychology. From Richardson's Clarissa to Woolf's Mrs. Dalloway, fiction's great project has been the exploration of inner life—the subtle movements of consciousness that external observation cannot capture. This inward turn is what distinguishes the novel from epic and romance, which concern themselves with public actions and collective destinies. The novel's affinity for subjectivity is not accidental but structural: prose fiction, with its capacity for sustained introspection, is uniquely suited to render the texture of lived experience from the inside. Passage 2 To claim that the novel is primarily about interiority is to ignore most of what novels have actually done. The great tradition of social fiction—from Balzac to Dickens to Tolstoy—concerns itself precisely with the public world, with the ways individuals are shaped by and in turn shape their societies. Even novels that seem intensely psychological, like Dostoevsky's, are ultimately about ideas and their consequences, not private feelings. The novel's genius lies in its capaciousness, its ability to contain both inner and outer, psychological and social. To reduce it to one dimension is to miss the point.		

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	The author of Passage 2 would most likely characterize the argument in Passage 1 as? a. accurately describing the novel's distinctive feature b. overlooking the social dimensions of fiction c. confusing the novel with poetry and drama d. correctly identifying the novel's structural capacity		
8	Craft and Structure		
	The following text is from Herman Melville's 1851 novel Moby-Dick. "Surely all this is not without meaning. And still deeper the meaning of that story of Narcissus, who because he could not grasp the tormenting, mild image he saw in the fountain, plunged into it and was drowned. But that same image, we ourselves see in all rivers and oceans. It is the image of the ungraspable phantom of life; and this is the key to it all." Which choice best states the function of the reference to Narcissus in the text? a. It introduces a classical parallel that explains the narrator's fascination with the sea. b. It contrasts the beauty of nature with the tragedy of human desire. c. It illustrates the danger of becoming obsessed with one's own reflection. d. It provides a mythological example of the human longing for the unattainable.		
9	Craft and Structure		
	The philosopher Hannah Arendt's concept of the "banality of evil" remains widely misunderstood. When she coined the phrase to describe Adolf Eichmann, she did not mean that evil had become ordinary or that Eichmann was an innocent bureaucrat following orders. Rather, she meant that tremendous evil could be perpetrated by someone utterly devoid of depth—someone whose thinking was clichéd, whose motivations were shallow, whose entire mode of being was thoughtless. The banality lay not in the acts but in the actor: evil could spring not from monstrous will but from an absence of thought altogether. As used in the text, "banality" most nearly means? a. ordinariness b. predictability c. thoughtlessness d. commonness		
10	Information and Ideas		
	Researchers studying sleep patterns in adolescents tracked 2,500 students from ages 14 to 18, measuring total sleep time and academic performance across four school years. The data revealed a consistent pattern: students who averaged less than six hours of sleep per night during exam periods scored, on average, 12% lower than their typical performance, even when controlling for prior achievement and socioeconomic status. However, the same students showed no significant decline when sleep deprivation occurred during non-exam periods. The researchers hypothesize that cognitive demands of testing create a vulnerability to sleep loss that routine academic work does not. Which choice best states the main finding of the study? a. Adolescents require more sleep than previously believed to maintain academic performance.		

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b. Sleep deprivation affects test performance more than routine academic work.
c. Students from lower socioeconomic backgrounds are more vulnerable to sleep loss.
d. Academic performance declines when students average less than six hours of sleep.

11 Information and Ideas

Soil Type	Water Retention (mL/100g)	Nutrient Content (1-10)	Crop Yield (kg/plot)
Sandy	22	4	3.8
Loamy	58	8	7.2
Clay	71	6	5.1
Silty	64	7	6.4

An agricultural researcher claims that nutrient content is the single most important factor determining crop yield. Which statement best explains how the data challenge this claim?

a. Sandy soil has the lowest nutrient content and the lowest yield, supporting the claim.
b. Clay soil has higher water retention than loamy soil but lower yield, suggesting other factors matter.
c. Peaty soil has the highest nutrient content but not the highest yield, contradicting the claim.
d. Silty soil has moderate nutrient content but relatively high yield, consistent with the claim.

12 Information and Ideas

The following text is from Charlotte Brontë's 1847 novel Jane Eyre.

"Women are supposed to be very calm generally: but women feel just as men feel; they need exercise for their faculties, and a field for their efforts as much as their brothers do; they suffer from too rigid a restraint, too absolute a stagnation, precisely as men would suffer; and it is narrow-minded in their more privileged fellow-creatures to say that they ought to confine themselves to making puddings and knitting stockings, to playing on the piano and embroidering bags."

Which choice best summarizes the text?

a. Women are inherently as capable as men and deserve equal opportunities.
b. The domestic tasks assigned to women are beneath their intellectual capacities.
c. Women experience the same needs for mental stimulation as men do.
d. Men are narrow-minded for restricting women to household occupations

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13	Information and Ideas		
	In a study of language acquisition, researchers compared two groups of children learning Mandarin: one group received immersive instruction with native speakers, while the other learned through a computer program with identical vocabulary and grammar content. After six months, both groups showed comparable vocabulary size and grammatical accuracy. However, when tested on tonal discrimination—a crucial feature of Mandarin—the immersion group significantly outperformed the computer group. The researchers concluded that while digital tools can effectively transmit explicit linguistic knowledge, certain aspects of language, particularly those requiring fine auditory discrimination, may depend on live human interaction for optimal development. According to the text, what was the key difference between the two groups' outcomes? a. The immersion group learned vocabulary faster than the computer group. b. The computer group showed better grammatical accuracy than expected. c. The immersion group developed a superior ability to distinguish tones. d. The computer group struggled with all aspects of Mandarin equally.		
14	Information and Ideas		
	The Gutian period in Mesopotamian history (c. 2150-2050 BCE) has traditionally been characterized as a dark age of barbarian invasion and cultural decline. This assessment derives primarily from later Sumerian sources, which describe the Gutians as "mountain dogs" and "a horde that knows no kingship." Yet recent archaeological evidence complicates this picture. Excavations at sites like Tell Brak and Nippur reveal continued scribal activity, temple construction, and international trade during Gutian rule. The Gutians, it appears, adopted cuneiform writing, patronized local cults, and gradually assimilated into Mesopotamian culture. The traditional narrative may tell us more about Sumerian propaganda than about Gutian realities. The author implies that later Sumerian sources are unreliable because they? a. were written centuries after the events they describe b. reflect political bias rather than objective history c. contradict all available archaeological evidence d. were composed by Gutian scribes under compulsion		
15	Information and Ideas		
	A study of urban heat island effects measured surface temperatures across different land cover types in a mid-sized city during a July heatwave.		

Land Cover Type	Average Surface Temperature (°C)
Dense Urban (Downtown)	41.2
Residential (High Density)	38.5
Residential (Low Density)	36.1

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Industrial Zone	42.8	
Urban Park (> 5 acres)	31.4	
Urban Park (< 1 acre)	33.9	

Researchers also found that parks larger than five acres cooled surrounding areas up to 150 meters beyond their boundaries, while parks smaller than one acre had no measurable cooling effect beyond their immediate borders.

Which claim is best supported by the data and information?

a. Industrial zones are consistently cooler than dense urban areas.
b. Park size determines both local temperature and cooling distance.
c. All green spaces provide equivalent cooling benefits.
d. Low-density residential areas are warmer than urban parks.

16 Information and Ideas

The concept of cultural capital, developed by sociologist Pierre Bourdieu, refers to non-financial social assets that promote social mobility. Knowledge of high-status cultural practices—appreciation of classical music, familiarity with fine dining etiquette, fluency in prestigious linguistic styles—functions as a resource that can be converted into educational credentials and professional opportunities. Bourdieu's insight was that educational systems, ostensibly meritocratic, actually reward this cultural capital, which children from privileged backgrounds acquire through family socialization while working-class children must learn without home reinforcement. Cultural capital is thus a mechanism of social reproduction, transmitting privilege across generations while appearing to reward individual merit.

According to the passage, educational systems appear meritocratic because they?

a. provide equal resources to all students regardless of background
b. reward abilities that seem individual rather than socially inherited
c. actively work to overcome disadvantages through targeted programs
d. measure native intelligence rather than acquired cultural knowledge

17 Information and Ideas

The paleoanthropological discovery of Homo floresiensis, the so-called "hobbit" of Flores Island, challenged fundamental assumptions about human evolution. Standing just over one meter tall with brains smaller than those of chimpanzees, these hominins lived until approximately 50,000 years ago—contemporaneous with modern humans. Their existence contradicts the prevailing narrative of progressive encephalization: bigger brains did not always confer evolutionary advantage. The Flores find also raises questions about island dwarfism, a phenomenon observed in other mammals where large species evolve smaller forms on islands with limited resources.

The discovery of Homo floresiensis challenged which assumption about human evolution?

a. That all hominin species went extinct by 100,000 years ago
b. That brain size consistently increased over evolutionary time
c. That island environments always produce smaller species

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d. That modern humans coexisted with other hominin species

18 Information and Ideas

A team of materials scientists tested the hardness and elastic strain limit of a new metallic glass (Alloy X) compared to two common crystalline steels.

Material	Hardness (Vickers)	Elastic Strain Limit (%)
Alloy X	650	2.1
Steel A (High-Strength Alloy)	500	0.8
Steel B (Spring Steel)	400	1.5

A designer needs a material for a flexible electronic screen that must bend significantly without permanent damage and resist scratches. Based on the data, which material would be most suitable?

a. Alloy X, because it has the highest hardness and highest elastic strain limit
b. Steel A, because it has the highest hardness
c. Steel B, because it has the highest elastic strain limit
d. A combination of Steel A for hardness and Steel B for flexibility

19 Standard English Convention

The collection of ancient manuscripts, some of which _ _ _ more than a thousand years old, provides invaluable insight into medieval monastic life.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

a. is
b. are
c. being
d. have been

20 Standard English Convention

The physicist carefully calibrated the spectrometer, adjusted the laser alignment, and _ _ _ the data collection software before beginning the experiment.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

a. initializing
b. had initialized
c. initialized
d. was initializing

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21	Standard English Convention		
	The artist's later works are notably different from _ _ _ created during her early period, reflecting her evolving philosophical concerns. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? a. those b. that c. them d. which		
22	Standard English Convention		
	_ _ _ the extreme weather conditions, the research team decided to continue their data collection rather than retreat to base camp. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? a. Despite b. Although c. Nevertheless d. However		
23	Standard English Convention		
	Each of the participants _ _ _ required to complete a questionnaire before the experiment began. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? a. were b. was c. have been d. are being		
24	Expression of Ideas		
	The writer is considering adding the following sentence to the end of a paragraph about urban development. "City planners must therefore balance economic growth with environmental protection to create sustainable communities." The writer wants to convey that this balance is not merely desirable but essential. Which revision best achieves this goal? a. City planners might therefore balance economic growth with environmental protection to create sustainable communities. b. City planners, therefore, have the option of balancing economic growth with environmental protection to create sustainable communities. c. City planners are therefore compelled to balance economic growth with environmental protection to create sustainable communities. d. City planners could therefore balance economic growth with environmental protection to create sustainable communities.		
25	Expression of Ideas		
	While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes: ● Ada Lovelace (1815-1852) was a mathematician and writer ● She collaborated with Charles Babbage on his Analytical Engine ● She translated an Italian article on the engine and added extensive notes		

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	• Her notes contained what is recognized as the first computer algorithm • She understood that machines could manipulate symbols beyond mere calculation • The programming language Ada is named in her honor The student wants to emphasize Lovelace's conceptual breakthrough rather than her historical circumstances. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal? a. Ada Lovelace, who collaborated with Charles Babbage on the Analytical Engine, wrote notes that contained the first computer algorithm. b. Translating an Italian article about Babbage's invention, Lovelace added extensive notes that demonstrated her mathematical abilities. c. Lovelace recognized that machines could manipulate symbols, not just calculate—a conceptual leap that anticipated modern computing. d. The programming language Ada honors Lovelace's contributions to computing, which included her work on the Analytical Engine.
26	Expression of Ideas
	The term "renaissance man" describes someone with expertise in multiple fields. Leonardo da Vinci exemplified this ideal through his achievements in art, science, engineering, and anatomy. _ _ _ his notebooks reveal investigations into optics, botany, and geology alongside sketches for paintings and inventions. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? a. Nevertheless, b. For instance, c. Consequently, d. By contrast,
27	Expression of Ideas
	The number of bee colonies in the region has declined dramatically over the past decade. _ _ _ local farmers have reported reduced crop yields in plants requiring pollination. The writer wants to indicate a cause-and-effect relationship. Which choice most effectively achieves the writer's goal? a. Meanwhile, b. Specifically, c. As a result, d. In addition,

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MODULE 2: Reading and Writing (27 Questions)

Direction:
The questions in this section address a number of important reading and writing skills. Each question includes one or more passages, which may include a table or graph. Read each passage and question carefully, and then choose the best answer to the question based on the passage(s).

All questions in this section are multiple-choice with four answer choices. Each question has a single best answer

NO	MATERI	SUB MATERI	KUNCI
1	Craft and Structure		
	The following text is from George Eliot's 1872 novel Middlemarch. "Signs are small measurable things, but interpretations are illimitable, and in girls of sweet, ardent nature, every sign is apt to conjure up wonder, hope, belief, vast as a sky, and colored by a diffused thimbleful of matter in the shape of knowledge." As used in the text, "illimitable" most nearly means? a. unpredictable b. without boundaries c. highly subjective d. impossible to verify		
2	Craft and Structure		
	The concept of orientalism, as articulated by Edward Said, describes the Western representation of Eastern societies as static, exotic, and fundamentally inferior. Said argued that these representations are not innocent descriptions but exercises of power: by defining the "Orient" as everything the "West" is not—irrational, despotic, aesthetic—European culture simultaneously defined itself as rational, democratic, and disciplined. The critique was never simply about accuracy; it was about the relationship between knowledge and power. Even scholarly works, Said maintained, participate in this dynamic when they assume the West's right to speak for and about the East without reciprocal engagement. Orientalism thus names not a body of falsehoods but a structure of thought that persists across otherwise diverse texts. Which choice best describes the function of the final sentence? a. It introduces an exception to Said's general argument. b. It clarifies that orientalism is a systemic pattern, not merely individual bias. c. It suggests that some Western scholarship avoids orientalist assumptions. d. It proposes a solution to the problem Said identifies.		
3	Craft and Structure		
	Passage 1 The sonnet form, with its fourteen lines and intricate rhyme schemes, might seem an artificial constraint on poetic expression. Yet for many poets, this very constraint enables creativity. The necessity of working within fixed parameters—the turn at the eighth line, the concluding		

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	couplet—forces choices that might not otherwise arise. Form becomes not a prison but a scaffold, supporting structures that could not stand alone. The sonnet's longevity testifies to this paradox: poets continue to choose it not despite its rules but because of them. Passage 2 The celebration of formal constraint mystifies what is actually a historical accident. The sonnet dominated European poetry for centuries not because of some intrinsic virtue but because educational systems privileged it, because patrons expected it, because publication venues favored it. Poets wrote sonnets for the same reasons contemporary songwriters write three-minute verses-chorus songs: because that's what the market demanded. To retroactively aestheticize this economic and social pressure is to confuse necessity with choice. The author of Passage 2 would most likely characterize the "paradox" mentioned in Passage 1 as? a. an accurate description of the creative process b. a misunderstanding of literary history c. a useful framework for teaching poetry d. an insight unique to modern poetics
4	Craft and Structure
	In his essay "Self-Reliance," Ralph Waldo Emerson urges readers to trust their own intuitions rather than conform to social expectations. "Whoso would be a man," he writes, "must be a nonconformist." Yet Emerson's individualism is not mere rebelliousness. He distinguishes between genuine self-trust and mere stubbornness, between following one's inner light and simply opposing whatever others think. The nonconformist Emerson admires is not the contrarian who defines himself against society, but the person who has discovered a source of guidance within—a source deeper than social convention and also deeper than personal whim. This inward turn is not easy; it requires what Emerson calls "self-reliance," a discipline of attending to one's own thoughts rather than borrowing them from others. The author suggests that Emerson's nonconformist differs from a mere contrarian in that the nonconformist? a. rejects all social conventions without exception b. follows an internal rather than reactive principle c. seeks to change society rather than escape it d. values solitude over any form of community
5	Craft and Structure
	The following text is from Frederick Douglass's 1845 autobiography Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass, an American Slave. "I have often been utterly astonished, since I came to the north, to find persons who could speak of the singing, among slaves, as evidence of their contentment and happiness. It is impossible to conceive of a greater mistake. Slaves sing most when they are most unhappy. The songs of the slave represent the sorrows of his heart; and he is relieved by them, only as an aching heart is relieved by its tears."

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	Which choice best describes the function of the final sentence? a. It introduces a new argument about the psychology of enslaved people. b. It explains through analogy why singing indicates sorrow rather than joy. c. It contrasts Northern and Southern interpretations of slave songs. d. It provides historical evidence for the cruelty of slavery.		
6	Craft and Structure		
	The philosopher Thomas Kuhn's concept of "paradigm shifts" transformed understanding of scientific change. Before Kuhn, science was often depicted as cumulative: knowledge gradually accumulates, with occasional corrections. Kuhn argued instead that science proceeds through revolutions. Normal science operates within a paradigm—a framework of assumptions, methods, and exemplars that defines legitimate problems and solutions. Anomalies accumulate, and eventually the paradigm breaks down, replaced by a new one that is "incommensurable" with the old. Kuhn's critics noted that "incommensurable" seemed to imply that paradigms are isolated from one another, that communication across revolutions is impossible. Kuhn insisted this was a misunderstanding: incommensurability meant lack of common measure, not incomparability. Different paradigms can be compared, but not by appeal to neutral standards that exist independently of both. As used in the text, "incommensurable" most nearly means? a. impossible to compare b. lacking shared standards of evaluation c. fundamentally incompatible d. resistant to empirical testing		
7	Craft and Structure		
	Passage 1 The Renaissance was a period of radical rupture, a decisive break from the superstition and stagnation of the Middle Ages. Petrarch's sonnets, Leonardo's notebooks, and Michelangelo's David all testify to a new spirit—one that turned from divine contemplation toward human potential and worldly achievement. The period's own name for itself, "rebirth," captures this sense of awakening after centuries of slumber. Renaissance humanism did not merely continue medieval traditions but actively rejected them, recovering classical learning that had been lost or suppressed. Passage 2 The metaphor of "rebirth" obscures more than it reveals. Far from breaking with the Middle Ages, Renaissance thinkers built directly upon medieval foundations. The classical texts they cherished had been preserved, copied, and commented upon for centuries in monasteries and cathedral schools. Medieval universities had already developed humanistic methods of textual analysis. Even Petrarch, often called the first humanist, owned and annotated more medieval manuscripts than classical ones. The Renaissance was not an awakening from slumber but a continuation of work already in progress.		

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	Based on the texts, how would the author of Passage 2 most likely respond to the claim in Passage 1 that the Renaissance represented "a decisive break from the superstition and stagnation of the Middle Ages"? a. By agreeing that the Renaissance broke from medieval traditions but disputing that the Middle Ages were stagnant b. By arguing that the Renaissance was actually inferior to the medieval period in its artistic achievements c. By rejecting the premise entirely, maintaining that Renaissance thought continued rather than broke from medieval foundations d. By suggesting that the term "rebirth" accurately describes the period but for different reasons than those given in Passage 1		
8	Craft and Structure		
	The following text is from Charles Dickens's 1859 novel A Tale of Two Cities. "It was the best of times, it was the worst of times, it was the age of wisdom, it was the age of foolishness, it was the epoch of belief, it was the epoch of incredulity, it was the season of Light, it was the season of Darkness, it was the spring of hope, it was the winter of despair." The series of contrasting pairs in the sentence primarily serves to? a. establish the novel's setting in a period of historical transition b. suggest that all historical judgments are inherently contradictory c. create a rhythm that mimics the uncertainty of the era d. introduce the novel's central theme of duality and opposition		
9	Craft and Structure		
	The aesthetic category of the picturesque emerged in eighteenth-century Britain as a middle term between the beautiful and the sublime. The beautiful was smooth, gentle, and harmonious; the sublime was vast, terrifying, and overwhelming. The picturesque occupied intermediate ground: rough, varied, and irregular, but not overwhelmingly powerful. A crumbling ruin, a gnarled oak, a rustic cottage—these were picturesque subjects, appealing because they offered complexity without terror, variety without chaos. The picturesque domesticated the sublime's wildness while adding interest to beauty's blandness. It was, in effect, tourism's aesthetic: the landscape one could admire without being consumed by it. According to the passage, the picturesque differs from the sublime in that it? a. evokes terror rather than admiration b. offers variety without overwhelming power c. is found only in man-made structures d. requires no emotional response from the viewer		
10	Information and Ideas		
	Researchers studying the effects of caffeine on cognitive performance divided 100 volunteers into five groups. Each group received a different dose of caffeine, then completed tests of reaction time, memory, and problem-solving. The results are shown in the table.		

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Caffeine Dose (mg)	Reaction Time (ms)	Memory Score (%)	Problem-Solving Score (%)
0	320	72	68
50	305	75	71
100	290	78	75
200	285	79	76
400	295	74	70

Which claim is best supported by the data?

a. Higher caffeine doses consistently improve all cognitive measures.
b. Moderate caffeine doses optimize performance, but very high doses are less effective.
c. Caffeine has no significant effect on reaction time beyond 100 mg.
d. Memory is more sensitive to caffeine than problem-solving ability.

11 Information and Ideas

The Moche civilization of ancient Peru (c. 100-800 CE) left no written records, but their ceramic vessels provide remarkably detailed information about their world. Moche pots depict individuals, animals, plants, and scenes of warfare, ceremony, and daily life with such naturalistic precision that researchers can identify specific species and activities. The vessels functioned as both everyday containers and burial offerings, suggesting they carried meaning beyond utility. Some scholars interpret the more elaborate scenes as illustrating myths or rituals, though without texts, these interpretations remain speculative. What is certain is that Moche ceramics represent one of the most sustained visual records of any pre-literate society.

According to the text, why are Moche ceramics valuable to researchers?

a. They contain written texts that explain Moche beliefs.
b. They provide detailed visual information about Moche life.
c. They were traded throughout the ancient Andean world.
d. They reveal the names of Moche rulers and deities

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12 Information and Ideas

City	Population Density (people/km²)	Average Commute (minutes)	Public Transit Use (%)
City A	2,500	28	15
City B	5,800	35	42
City C	8,200	31	58
City D	3,100	24	12
City E	12,500	38	71

An urban planner hypothesizes that higher population density leads to greater public transit use. Which statement best explains how the data support this hypothesis?

a. City E has the highest density and the highest transit use, while City D has low density and low transit use.
b. City B has higher density than City A but lower transit use than City C.
c. City C has higher transit use than City B despite lower density.
d. City A and City D have similar transit use despite different densities.

13 Information and Ideas

The concept of biophilia, popularized by biologist E.O. Wilson, proposes that humans have an innate tendency to seek connections with nature and other forms of life. Wilson argued that this tendency evolved because our ancestors who attended to natural environments—who noticed animal tracks, recognized edible plants, and responded to landscape features—survived and reproduced more successfully. Biophilia is thus not cultural but biological, a legacy of our evolutionary history. Critics note that if biophilia is innate, it is remarkably unevenly expressed: many people prefer cities to wilderness, and environmental destruction continues apace. Wilson's response is that innate tendencies can be overridden by culture, just as our sweet tooth (an evolved preference for calorie-rich foods) can be overridden by dietary knowledge.

According to the text, how does Wilson address the criticism that people often prefer cities to nature?

a. He argues that cities contain their own forms of nature.
b. He maintains that innate tendencies can be culturally overridden.
c. He suggests that biophilia develops only in childhood.

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	d. He claims that environmental destruction proves biophilia is weak.		
14	Information and Ideas		
	Researchers studying plant communication discovered that when tomato plants are attacked by caterpillars, they release volatile organic compounds that alert neighboring plants. These "warning signals" cause nearby plants to activate chemical defenses before they themselves are attacked. In a controlled experiment, plants that received such signals suffered 30% less damage from subsequent caterpillar feeding than plants that did not. The signaling compounds are species-specific: tomato plants respond to signals from other tomato plants but not from unrelated species like sage or pepper. Which finding, if true, would most directly challenge the researchers' conclusion that the plants are "alerting" neighboring plants? a. The volatile compounds also attract parasitic wasps that prey on caterpillars. b. The compounds are released whether or not other plants are nearby. c. Plants that receive the signals grow more slowly than unalerted plants. d. The same compounds are released in response to mechanical damage.		
15	Information and Ideas		
	The following text is from John Muir's 1911 book My First Summer in the Sierra. "Another glorious Sierra day in which one seems to be dissolved and absorbed and sent pulsing onward we know not where. Life seems neither long nor short, and we take no more heed to save time or make haste than do the trees and stars. This is true freedom, a good practical sort of immortality." Which choice best summarizes Muir's perspective? a. Nature provides an escape from the burdens of human consciousness. b. The Sierra wilderness offers a unique experience of timelessness. c. Immortality can be achieved through communion with nature. d. Human concerns about time become meaningless in the wilderness.		
16	Information and Ideas		
	A study of historical climate data examined the relationship between volcanic eruptions and global temperatures. Researchers analyzed temperature records following 15 major eruptions over the past 500 years. They found that in every case, average global temperatures dropped by 0.3 to 0.6 degrees Celsius in the year following the eruption, with recovery to pre-eruption levels within three to five years. The cooling effect was more pronounced in the Northern Hemisphere, where most eruptions occurred, and lasted slightly longer there. The researchers conclude that volcanic aerosols reflect sunlight back into space, temporarily reducing the amount of solar energy reaching Earth's surface. According to the text, why do volcanic eruptions affect global temperatures? a. They release heat-trapping gases into the atmosphere. b. They eject particles that block incoming sunlight. c. They alter ocean circulation patterns. d. They destroy vegetation that absorbs carbon dioxide.		

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17 | Information and Ideas

The philosophical problem of free will has been reformulated by neuroscience. Traditional debates pitted libertarians (who believe in uncaused choice) against determinists (who believe all events are caused). But neuroscientific findings suggest a different picture. When people make decisions, brain activity predicting the choice can be detected seconds before the person is consciously aware of deciding. This suggests that conscious willing may not initiate action but rather reflect processes already underway. Some philosophers argue this doesn't eliminate free will—it just relocates it. Perhaps free will is not about initiating actions but about endorsing or identifying with them. The neuroscience, on this view, tells us about timing but not about the nature of agency itself.

The passage suggests that neuroscientific findings have?

a. definitively disproven the existence of free will
b. shifted rather than resolved the philosophical debate
c. shown that conscious decisions are illusory
d. confirmed the determinist position

18 | Information and Ideas

Tree Species	Average Lifespan (years)	Maximum Height (m)	Wood Density (g/cm³)
Bristlecone Pine	4,000	18	0.65
Coast Redwood	2,000	112	0.48
Douglas Fir	1,000	85	0.53
Quaking Aspen	80	25	0.44
Giant Sequoia	3,200	85	0.42

A student claims that tree species with longer lifespans tend to have denser wood. Which statement best explains whether the data support this claim?

a. They support the claim, as bristlecone pine has the longest lifespan and highest wood density.
b. They challenge the claim, as giant sequoia has a longer lifespan but lower wood density than Douglas fir.
c. They neither support nor challenge the claim because wood density varies within species.
d. They support the claim, as all long-lived species have wood density above 0.50 g/cm³

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19	Standard English Convention		
	Neither the conductor nor the orchestra members _ _ _ satisfied with the rehearsal space. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? a. was b. were c. has been d. is		
20	Standard English Convention		
	The professor insisted that each student submit _ _ _ essay by Friday, without exception. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? a. their b. his or her c. its d. our		
21	Standard English Convention		
	Had the researchers _ _ _ the potential confounding variables, their conclusions might have been more reliable. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? a. controlled for b. have controlled for c. to control for d. been controlling for		
22	Standard English Convention		
	The committee's recommendations, _ _ _ after months of deliberation, were finally presented to the board. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? a. developed b. developing c. having developed d. were developed		
23	Standard English Convention		
	_ _ _ the complexity of the subject, the lecture was remarkably clear and accessible to nonspecialists. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? a. Given b. Despite c. Although d. Because of		

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24	Expression of Ideas		
	While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes: ● The Library of Alexandria was founded in the 3rd century BCE in Egypt ● It aimed to collect all known works of Greek literature and scholarship ● Scholars at the library produced critical editions of Homer's epics ● The library also housed works from Persia, India, and other regions ● It was partially or completely destroyed, possibly multiple times ● The exact circumstances of its destruction remain unknown The student wants to emphasize the library's scholarly activities rather than its fate. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal? a. The Library of Alexandria, founded in the 3rd century BCE, collected Greek literature and produced critical editions of Homer. b. Although the Library of Alexandria was destroyed in circumstances still unknown, it had collected works from many regions. c. Scholars at the Library of Alexandria produced critical editions of Homer and studied texts from Persia and India. d. The Library of Alexandria aimed to collect all known Greek works and may have been destroyed multiple times.		
25	Expression of Ideas		
	The writer is revising a sentence for concision and precision. Original: "The reason why the experiment failed was due to the fact that the temperature was not controlled properly." Which revision best improves the sentence? a. The experiment failed due to improper temperature control. b. The reason for the experiment's failure was because of improper temperature control. c. The fact that the temperature was not controlled properly caused the experiment to fail. d. Improper temperature control is why the experiment failed.		
26	Expression of Ideas		
	Urban agriculture offers multiple benefits to city residents. Community gardens provide fresh produce in food deserts. Green spaces reduce the urban heat island effect. _ _ _ gardening activities promote physical exercise and mental well-being. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition and maintains parallel structure? a. Additionally, b. However, c. For example, d. Nevertheless,		
27	Expression of Ideas		
	The term "dark matter" refers to hypothetical matter that does not emit, absorb, or reflect light. Its existence is inferred from gravitational effects on visible matter. _ _ _ scientists cannot observe dark matter directly, its gravitational influence is unmistakable.		

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	Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? a. Because b. Although c. Therefore d. Unless

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